

Classic three-movers

C.G.S.Narayanan

"Variation play is now the most fundamental chess problem effect of all and is most satisfying when it is logically necessary" wrote Robin Mathews, one of the finest composers of all strategic three-movers of modern era. Robin's problem always provide aesthetic appeal because of the logic inherent in them. Of the following three-movers from his book "Mostly three movers". the first one below is a classic study quaternary black correction

Robin Matthews
I prize, Observer 1964



Mate in three moves

After the key **1.Bc6!** 2.Re3+) BNf4 any leads to 2.Rxe7+ followed by 3.Rxe6. I of e6. The play Ng6 revolves around the corrections by BN to squares g6, e6 and d5 which interfere on the bent line of BRh6. The first correction to the random move 1.Ng6 !leads to 2.c3 threatening 3.Bxd4 (if 2...dxc3, 3.d4+). wiith BRh6 but prevents 2.c3. Now white plays 2.Kxb2 threatening Nc4 as Bxf7 no longer defeats. The quaternary correction 1.Nd5!! further carries the error of interfering with both BRh6 and negates Kxb2 and c3.

Robin Matthews

I Pr, The Problemist 1984



Mate in three moves

1.Bf2! (2.Qb1 2.Qa2) 1,,,Ng4
2.Nb6+Rxb6 3.Qxd5 2.....Kxc5;3
Bxd4 ;1...Rc8 2Rxd4+Nxd4
3.Nb6;2...Kxd4 3.Qxd5;1...Nxa3
2..Qxd5+ Nxd5 3.Rxd4;2....Kxd5
3.Nb6;1...Bxa3 2.Qb1 Bb2 3.Ra4

In the second problem there are two defences, to attack on the thematic squares b6, d4 and d5 , in each case a direct guard and a K iflight

A problem or solving

Robin Matthews

Nosrk Sjakklblad 1987



Mate in three moves

Solution to problem for solving in the article 'Solving difficulty': key 1.Nf7!
(2.Ng5) 1...Nf3 2.Nc;5;1...R(3)a5
2.Nd4;1...R(a8)a5 2.Nd8. Two unpins
WN b3

Readers may send in their queries to
cgsnarayanan@hotmail.com